Crown attachment checklist

D2740 and the rest of the crown family · what to attach before it leaves

A crown claim usually fails on evidence, not eligibility. The reviewer needs to see why this tooth needed a crown and not a filling — that is a structure question, and it is answered by the records you kept.

BEFORE THE PREP

- ☐ **Pre-operative radiograph:** diagnostic-quality bitewing and periapical of the tooth, readable, dated, and in the packet.
- ☐ **Intraoral photos:** before the prep, during the prep, and after delivery. Three frames answer most questions in one page.
- ☐ **Clinical note:** what you found and what you removed. Fracture line, decay, failing restoration, cusps involved, percentage of tooth structure lost, symptoms.
- ☐ **Why not a filling:** write this line every time. It is the single sentence that prevents a downgrade to a base or permanent restoration.

AT DELIVERY

- ☐ **Tooth and code:** tooth number, ADA code, material, shade, and whether it is permanent or provisional.
- ☐ **Initial or replacement:** if replacement, the prior placement date, the prior material, and why it failed.
- ☐ **Margin and core:** subgingival margin depth, core buildup or post if placed, and the date of the final impression.
- ☐ **Narrative:** what remains of the tooth, retention method, and the reason the restoration was indicated.

ANSWER THE THREE DENIALS YOU WILL ACTUALLY GET

1. **"Not medically necessary."** Send the pre-op radiograph plus the structure-loss note. The photo of the prepared tooth settles it.
2. **"Missing attachment."** Resend with the photo set and the delivery date on the cover sheet; ask the clearinghouse to confirm the attachment transmitted.
3. **"Frequency limit reached."** Prove the date of the previous crown. If the record is short, say so and appeal on replacement of a failed restoration.

File naming: name every attachment with the claim number, patient ID and tooth number before it leaves the office. Unnamed images get filed and never read.

We attach what the payer will accept, first time.

Our attachment review runs on every claim we submit — radiographs, photos and notes the reviewer can act on.

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